

SAMPLE STUDENT RESPONSES, POSITION “FOR”

The following are sample written responses from students during the Citizen Math lesson Coupon Clipping in which students reason with percents and proportions to evaluate enticing coupons and debate whether retailers should be allowed to raise the price of items in order to then put them on sale. All responses take the same stance, but offer different levels of support.

Q5b. Do you think stores should be allowed to raise prices before offering discounts? Explain.

I think businesses can decide the price however they want. If you don't like it, go shop somewhere else.

Q5b. Do you think stores should be allowed to raise prices before offering discounts? Explain.

Well there's a lot of ways to do sales. Some companies raise prices first and others might already have higher prices before they put things on sale.

Q5b. Do you think stores should be allowed to raise prices before offering discounts? Explain.

If a business wants to make fake sales, I think that's fine because you don't have to shop there. My reason is that people like sales even if the price is higher. So it's just smart business to mark things as "on sale" even if you're charging the same price you were always going to charge

Q5b. Do you think stores should be allowed to raise prices before offering discounts? Explain.

Stores should be able to make sales however they want!

My evidence that customers want sales is that when JC Penney tried to stop having "fake" sales everyone stopped shopping there. So they had to bring back the sales to make customers happy and want to shop there again.

Someone might counter that a bunch of stores were sued for cheating customers with "fake" discounts. But from the customer's perspective those BIG sales are still what they want so no one is really harmed. Plus, there is no "real" price for items in the first place because the price is whatever people are willing to pay.

SAMPLE STUDENT RESPONSES, POSITION “AGAINST”

The following are sample written responses from students during the Citizen Math lesson Coupon Clipping, in which students reason with percents and proportions to evaluate enticing coupons and debate whether retailers should be allowed to raise the price of items in order to then put them on sale. All responses take the same stance, but offer different levels of support.

Q5b. Do you think stores should be allowed to raise prices before offering discounts? Explain.

I think businesses should not be able to lie about prices. That's not fair to customers!

Q5b. Do you think stores should be allowed to raise prices before offering discounts? Explain.

They are deceiving customers when they publicize a big discount on a fake price that they'd never actually charge.

Q5b. Do you think stores should be allowed to raise prices before offering discounts? Explain.

Even though the store isn't actually stealing money from the customer, they are still tricking people into thinking their getting more value than they actually are.

Q5b. Do you think stores should be allowed to raise prices before offering discounts? Explain.

Stores should not be allowed to raise prices just for sales because it's dishonest.

My evidence is that the stores like JC Penney are increasing prices just so they can trick people into thinking they are getting big discounts.

Even though JC Penney found out their customers wanted the fake sales, it is still misleading people into thinking they are buying something of a higher value than it actually is. So it's fraud and should not be allowed.